MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026 - Fourth SEMESTER **Q.P. 25901525**

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG4DSCSWK200 - **Social Work Practice with Individuals & Groups**

Part A Very Short Answer Answer all questions Each question carries 1 marks

1. State the contribution of Mary Richmond to case work. - [K] / [CO1]
   - Introduced **scientific approach** to case work
   - Developed **diagnostic and treatment methods**
   - Highlighted importance of **social environment**
   - Promoted **professional training** in social work

2. Record one purpose of observation in case work practice. - [K] / [CO3]
To understand client behavior and emotions in real situations

3. Define facilitation skill. - [K] / [CO3]
Facilitation skill is the **ability to guide individuals or groups** to communicate effectively, participate actively, and achieve their goals.

4. List two objectives of pre-group planning. - [K] / [CO4]
   - To **identify group goals and objectives**
   - To **select appropriate members and structure the group**

5. Define Social Treatment in Social Case Work.- [K] / [CO3]
Social treatment refers to the **process of helping individuals adjust to their environment** through planned interventions and support.

6. Define confidentiality in social case work. - [K] / [CO2]
Confidentiality is the **ethical obligation to keep client information private** and not disclose it without consent.

7. State the meaning of termination in case work practice. - [K] / [CO3]
Termination is the **planned ending of the helping relationship** after achieving goals or when services are no longer needed.

8. Name two forms of Social Control. - [K] / [CO5]
Formal social control (laws, rules, institutions)
Informal social control (family, customs, traditions)

9. State the characteristics of the storming stage. [K] / [CO5]
Conflict and disagreement among members
Power struggles and resistance
Emotional tension and competition
Testing group boundaries

10. List the roles of a group worker in facilitating interaction- [K] / [CO5].
Encouraging **participation of all members**
Promoting **open communication**
Managing **conflicts effectively**
Creating a **supportive environment**

Part B Short Answer Answer any 5 questions Each question carries 3 marks

11. Explain the concept of "Person" as a component of social case work**.** **- [U] / [CO1 -3 marks**
Refers to the **individual client with unique personality, needs, and problems**
Emphasizes **individual differences and dignity of the person**
Focuses on **interaction between person and environmen**

12. Explain how case work practice differs in medical and correctional settings**.-** **[U] / [CO3- 3 marks**
Medical setting: Focus on illness, recovery, and emotional support to patients
Correctional setting: Focus on rehabilitation, behavior change, and reintegration
Approach differs: Therapeutic care vs corrective and reformative intervention

13. Differentiate between Field Theory and Exchange Theory. - [**An] / [CO3]- 3 marks**

Field Theory: Behavior influenced by **person and environment interaction**
Exchange Theory: Focus on **cost–benefit analysis in relationships**
Field = situational forces, Exchange = **rewards and reciprocity**

14. Differentiate between a process record and a summary record in social group work. - **[An] / [CO6] 3 marks**

Process Record: Detailed, verbatim account of group interaction
Summary Record: Brief, condensed version of key events
Use: Process = analysis; Summary = quick reference/report

15. Explain the importance of empathy in social case work practice. - **[U] / [CO3] -3 marks**

Helps in **understanding client's feelings deeply**
Builds **trust and strong worker-client relationship**
Encourages **client openness and participation**

16. Review the relevance of acceptance and non-judgmental attitude in case work. **- [U] / [CO2] -3 marks**

- Promotes **respect and dignity of the client**
- Creates a **safe and supportive environment**
- Avoids bias, enabling **objective problem-solving**

17. Explain the importance of leadership in social group work **.- [A] / [CO4]- 3 marks**

Provides **direction and structure to the group**
Facilitates **participation and cooperation**
Helps in **conflict resolution and goal achievement**

Part C Short Essay Answer any 3 questions Each question carries 5 marks

18. Demonstrate how a social worker can manage transference in professional practice. -] **[A] / [CO3] - 5marks**

- Recognize and **identify client's transferred feelings** toward the worker
- Maintain **professional boundaries and objectivity**
- Use **self-awareness** to avoid emotional involvement
- Interpret transference carefully to **understand client's past relationships**
- Use supervision or consultation to **handle complex emotional situations**

19. Illustrate the contents of Social Diagnosis with a suitable case example. -] [A] / [CO3] - **5marks**

- Collection of **detailed personal and social history** of the client
- Analysis of **causes of the problem** (social, psychological, economic)
- Assessment of **client strengths and weaknesses**
- Understanding of **environmental factors** influencing the issue
- Example: A child with school dropout—diagnosis includes **family poverty, lack of support, and low motivation**

20. Analyze the different types of groups in social work.- [An] / [CO3] - **5marks**

- **Primary groups:** Close, personal relationships (family)
- **Secondary groups:** Formal, goal-oriented (organizations)
- **Therapeutic groups:** Focus on emotional healing and support
- **Task groups:** Formed to achieve specific objectives
- **Self-help groups:** Members share common problems and support each other

21. Analyze communication patterns in group work practice.- [An] / [CO5] - **5marks**

- **One-way communication:** Leader-centered, limited participation
- **Two-way communication:** Interaction between leader and members
- **Multi-directional communication:** Free interaction among all members
- Patterns influence **group cohesion and participation**
- Effective communication promotes **understanding and goal achievement**

22. Explain how historical developments shaped current group work practice . [A] / [CO5 - **5marks**

- Early roots in **settlement houses and charity organizations**
- Influence of **industrialization and urbanization** on group needs
- Development during **World Wars for rehabilitation and morale building**
- Professionalization through **education and training in social work**
- Modern practice influenced by **psychological and sociological theories**

Part D Essay Answer any 2 questions Each question carries 15 marks

23. Assess the strengths and limitations of Sociometry & Sociograms in professional group work practice. **E] / [CO5]**

Strengths **7 marks**

- Identifies group relationships: Helps understand patterns of attraction, rejection, and interaction among members
- Detects group structure: Reveals leaders, isolates, cliques, and sub-groups within the group
- Improves group functioning: Assists the worker in planning interventions to enhance cohesion and participation
- Visual representation: Sociograms provide a clear and simple diagram of complex relationships
- Useful for decision-making: Helps in forming balanced groups and assigning roles effectively

Limitations **7 marks**

- Risk of labeling: Members may feel stigmatized as "isolates" or "rejected"
- Depends on honesty: Accuracy relies on truthful responses from members
- Time-consuming process: Data collection and diagramming require effort and skill
- Static in nature: Captures relationships at one point; may not reflect changing dynamics
- Ethical concerns: Issues of confidentiality and misuse of sensitive interpersonal data

Conclusion **1 marks**

Sociometry and sociograms are powerful tools for understanding group dynamics, but they must be used carefully and ethically to avoid harm and ensure accurate interpretation.

24. Explain the stages of the group work process, including pre-group planning, beginning, middle, and ending phases, and analyze their significance in achieving group objectives. - **[E] / [CO6]**

1. Pre-Group Planning Stage **3marks**

Key Activities	Significance
➢ Identifying **purpose and objectives** of the group ➢ Selection of **members** based on needs and compatibility ➢ Deciding **group size, structure, and duration** ➢ Planning **programs and activities** ➢ Arranging **resources and setting**	➢ Ensures **clarity of goals and direction** ➢ Helps in forming a **balanced and effective group** ➢ Prevents future conflicts through **careful selection and planning** ➢ Provides a **strong base** for group functioning

4marks

2. Beginning Stage

Key Activities	Significance
• Introduction of members and worker • Establishing **rules, norms, and expectations** • Building **trust and rapport** • Clarifying **goals and roles**	• Creates a **safe and supportive environment** • Promotes **member participation and cooperation** • Reduces anxiety and uncertainty among members • Lays the groundwork for **group cohesion**

4marks

3. Middle Stage

Key Activities	Significance
➢ Active **interaction and participation** among members ➢ **Problem-solving and decision-making** ➢ Handling **conflicts and resistance** ➢ Encouraging **leadership and cooperation**	➢ Helps in achieving **group goals and objectives** ➢ Promotes **learning, behavior change, and development** ➢ Strengthens **group relationships and cohesion** ➢ Develops **skills such as communication and leadership**

4marks

4. Ending Stage

Key Activities	Significance
• Evaluation of **group performance and outcomes** • Reviewing **achievements and experiences** • Preparing members for **termination** • Providing **follow-up or referrals if needed**	• Ensures **proper closure** of the group process • Reinforces **learning and achievements** • Helps members deal with **feelings of separation1** • Assesses the **effectiveness of the group**

25. Analyze the role of intake and psycho-social study in assessment and intervention planning in social case work. - [An] / [CO3].

Social case work is a **systematic method of helping individuals** solve personal and social problems. Two crucial initial steps—**intake** and **psycho-social study**—form the foundation for accurate assessment and effective intervention planning.

1. Role of Intake

Meaning-Intake is the **first contact** between the client and the social worker, where basic information is collected and the problem is identified**.**

Key Roles in Assessment	Contribution to Intervention Planning
➢ Collects **preliminary data** about the client and presenting problem ➢ Helps in **screening and deciding eligibility** for services ➢ Establishes **initial rapport and trust** ➢ Clarifies the **nature, urgency, and scope of the problem** ➢ Determines whether **referral or further study** is needed	➢ Provides a **starting point for case formulation** ➢ Helps in setting **initial goals and priorities** ➢ Guides decision on **type of service or agency response**

2. Role of Psycho-social Study

Meaning- Psycho-social study is a **detailed investigation** of the client's personality, social environment, and life situation.

Key Roles in Assessment	Contribution to Intervention Planning
➢ Analyzes **personal, emotional, and behavioral aspects** ➢ Examines **family, social, and environmental factors** ➢ Identifies **causes and contributing factors** of the problem ➢ Assesses **strengths, resources, and coping abilities** ➢ Provides a **holistic understanding of the client**	➢ Forms the basis for **accurate diagnosis (social diagnosis)** ➢ Helps design **individualized intervention strategies** ➢ Assists in selecting **appropriate techniques and approaches** ➢ Enables **goal setting based on client needs and strengths**

3. Analytical Perspective

- Intake is **brief and exploratory**, while psycho-social study is **in-depth and analytical**
- Intake identifies the **problem**, whereas psycho-social study explains the **causes and context**
- Both are **interrelated and complementary**
- Together they ensure **scientific, systematic, and client-centered practice**

6 mark

6 mark

3 mark

26. Compare social case work and social group work with suitable examples, and analyze the principles underlying each method in professional social work practice- [An] / [CO2

Social Case Work:

- Focus on **individual client problems**
- One-to-one relationship
- Uses principles like **individualization and confidentiality**
- Example: Counseling a person with anxiety

6 mark

Social Group Work:

- Focus on **group interaction and collective growth**
- Works with multiple members
- Uses principles like **group dynamics and participation**
- Example: Support group for substance abuse recovery

6 mark

Analysis:

- Case work emphasizes **personalized intervention**, while group work emphasizes **mutual aid and social learning**
- Both aim at **social adjustment and development**, using different methods

3 mark